CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 5

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She is getting supplies for her landlord.
- She wants to redecorate her new place.
- She needs to replace her old curtains.
- She is looking to buy new chair cushions.

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- the female customer
- the maintenance worker
- the salesman's brother
- the woman's landlord

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- a chair cover
- some curtains
- a cushion
- some paint

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- He likes them very much.
- He would like to see them.
- They are like his own curtains.
- They will be difficult to match.

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She would prefer to live there.
- She dislikes the colour of its walls.
- She wishes it was near the ocean.
- She thinks it needs more sunlight.

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

-
-
-
-

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- His ladder is broken.
- His ladder isn't tall enough.
- He doesn't have a stepladder.
- He wants to have an extra ladder.

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- She now has everything that she needs.
- She needs to come back to the store.
- She must get her landlord to visit the store.
- She changes her mind about the project.

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- at a nearby restaurant
- at the woman's desk
- in a coffee shop
- in their boss's office

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- Her birthday is today.
- The boss is treating everyone.
- She forgot to bring her lunch.
- She is part of the team.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- She doesn't like trying new food.
- She has never eaten Italian food.
- She prefers her own ethnic food.
- She prefers sushi to Italian food.

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- It's the company's monthly event.
- It's the tradition that she knows.
- The boss promised everyone so.
- The man told her the boss would pay.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- She'll go if the boss pays.
- She'd prefer to eat in the office.
- She will join them today.
- She will wait for her birthday.

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- to show her the repairs he completed
- to learn what work she wants done
- to inquire about working for her
- to teach her how to do her repairs

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- to dust the area after sanding
- to have the work completed soon
- to purchase extra floor tiles
- to start the repairs that day

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- bought an electric sander
- cleaned the floor tiles
- repaired the damaged wall
- painted the whole room

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- The estimate will be more accurate.
- The new floor would look better.
- The tiles match the cupboard handles.
- The man brought enough tiles.

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- whether she measured correctly
- being able to make dinner on time
- when he will complete the job
- preparing meals in a dirty area

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- by the end of day
- within one week
- just over a week
- in three weeks

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. Heavy rain caused Jila's slide to _____
- ◯ slip into the neighbour's yard.
- ◯ slip into a park.
- ◯ fall over in her yard.
- ◯ break into pieces on the hill.

2. The town council decided to _____
- ◯ buy her a new slide.
- ◯ charge her for damage.
- ◯ make repairs to the slide.
- ◯ remove the slide.

3. The council's decision made Jila _____
- ◯ excited.
- ◯ angry.
- ◯ pleased.
- ◯ upset.

4. Several days later another storm _____
- ◯ covered the artist's work in mud.
- ◯ damaged the park playground.
- ◯ knocked a tree onto the slide.
- ◯ destroyed the climbing structure.

5. Townspeople hired Eddy Galen to _____
- ◯ build a new climbing structure.
- ◯ make a new slide for Jila's garden.
- ◯ create artwork in the park.
- ◯ make the playground safer.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What change is Tia describing?
- ◯ Their company has rented out office space.
- ◯ Their workspace has been arranged differently.
- ◯ Their team members have been reassigned duties.
- ◯ Their office has moved to a new location.

2. What is Richard's main concern?
- ◯ that he will no longer work with the same people
- ◯ that the office will be louder than it was before
- ◯ that his phone calls will no longer be private
- ◯ that meetings will be more difficult to arrange

3. Who would NOT be affected by the change?
- ◯ those who work in the office every day
- ◯ those who have clients visiting the office
- ◯ those who need daily telephone access
- ◯ those who regularly consult with their team

4. According to Tia, what is an advantage of this change?
- ◯ Teams will be able to work together.
- ◯ Business will grow more quickly.
- ◯ Space will be used more efficiently.
- ◯ Noise will be significantly reduced.

5. What change has recently affected the company?
- ◯ It has acquired more business contracts.
- ◯ It has moved into a new type of industry.
- ◯ It has signed up for a team phone plan.
- ◯ It has eliminated a flexible work schedule.

6. What most upsets Alice?
- ◯ irregular work hours
- ◯ difficult phone access
- ◯ increased workplace noise
- ◯ reduced team discussions

PART 5

7. What seems true about the three speakers?

- ◯ rThey were not working with clients before.
- ◯ They spend the entire work day in the office.
- ◯ They were not consulted about the changes.
- ◯ They have their own private office at work.

8. Why do the three people seem happy at the end?

- ◯ They've grasped the new system well.
- ◯ They've agreed on a workable solution.
- ◯ They've decided to challenge the new plan.
- ◯ They've recognized many outside opportunities.

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. Generally speaking, Canadians are _____

- ◯ ambivalent towards the health-care system.
- ◯ critical of the health-care system.
- ◯ inadequately served by the health-care system.
- ◯ quite proud of the health-care system.

2. Some Canadians argue that _____

- ◯ Canada cannot afford the current health-care system.
- ◯ health care generates a heavy tax burden.
- ◯ the government should privatize all health services.
- ◯ the government needs to improve the training of doctors.

3. A criticism of Canadian health care is that _____

- ◯ it monopolizes health service provision.
- ◯ it provides inequitable services to citizens.
- ◯ the health system spends money inefficiently.
- ◯ Canadian services are inferior to European services.

4. One argument mentioned for a mixed system is that _____

- ◯ health expenditure will decrease.
- ◯ wait-lists will become shorter.
- ◯ the tax burden will be eased.
- ◯ doctors can choose where to work.

5. Critics of the current system argue that _____

- ◯ taxation should be proportional to service use.
- ◯ citizens are entitled to choose their service providers.
- ◯ quality of service should be proportional to taxation.
- ◯ the government shouldn't compromise the current system.

6. A compromise solution would allow private clinics to _____

- ◯ treat wealthy patients with specific diseases.
- ◯ open only in more affluent neighborhoods.
- ◯ offer free health care to those who cannot pay.
- ◯ provide health screening and diagnostic services.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	She wants to redecorate her new place.
Question 2	the woman's landlord
Question 3	some curtains
Question 4	He likes them very much.
Question 5	She dislikes the colour of its walls.
Question 6	
Question 7	His ladder is broken.
Question 8	She now has everything that she needs.

PART 2	
Question 1	at the woman's desk
Question 2	She is part of the team.
Question 3	She has never eaten Italian food.
Question 4	It's the tradition that she knows.
Question 5	She will join them today.

PART 3	
Question 1	to learn what work she wants done
Question 2	to have the work completed soon
Question 3	repaired the damaged wall
Question 4	The new floor would look better.
Question 5	preparing meals in a dirty area
Question 6	within one week

PART 4	
Question 1	slip into a park.
Question 2	buy her a new slide.
Question 3	pleased.
Question 4	knocked a tree onto the slide.
Question 5	build a new climbing structure.

PART 5	
Question 1	Their workspace has been arranged differently.
Question 2	that meetings will be more difficult to arrange
Question 3	those who work in the office every day
Question 4	Space will be used more efficiently.
Question 5	It has acquired more business contracts.
Question 6	reduced team discussions
Question 7	They were not consulted about the changes.
Question 8	They've agreed on a workable solution.

PART 6	
Question 1	quite proud of the health-care system.
Question 2	health care generates a heavy tax burden.
Question 3	it monopolizes health service provision.
Question 4	wait-lists will become shorter.
Question 5	citizens are entitled to choose their service providers.
Question 6	provide health screening and diagnostic services.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between two people at a retail store. The man works there; the woman is a customer.

Section 1:

MAN: Hi, how can I help you today?

WOMAN: I just rented a studio apartment, and I'd like to paint the room.

MAN: Oh, your landlord will let you do that?

WOMAN: Excuse me?

MAN: When my brother moved into a rental apartment, he wanted to repaint the place too, but he had to get permission from his landlord first. The good thing was that the landlord paid for it. Usually, they're responsible for maintenance and repairs.

WOMAN: Oh, I didn't know that. I guess I'd better ask first then.

MAN: Might be a good idea. Is there anything in the apartment that you want the paint to match? You could always bring in a chair, but a cushion would be easier!

WOMAN: Actually, I'd like the paint to match the curtains. My grandmother made them, so I don't want to replace them. Great suggestion! Thanks!

Now answer questions 1-3.

1. Why does the woman go to the store?
2. Who is probably responsible for maintenance and repairs?
3. What will the woman likely bring if she returns?

Section 2:

MAN: You're back! With curtains! Oh, I can see why you don't want to replace them!

WOMAN: Do you think we can match this shade of blue?

MAN: Yes, but are you sure you want to do that? If the walls are the same colour, you won't really notice the curtains.

WOMAN: Oh, good point. So . . . um . . . how about THAT colour?

MAN: The light green? I was thinking you might want white or beige.

WOMAN: Ugh—too much like my parents' house! No, actually, with the light green and blue, the room will look like the ocean, near where I used to live. I miss it a lot, how the bright sun made the water look different shades of blue . . .

MAN: Then the light green is a perfect choice! Now you'll also need a roller, a pan, some masking tape for around the windows, and a brush. You can get those today. Do you need a drop cloth?

WOMAN: What's that?

MAN: It's a big piece of cloth to cover the floor. Your landlord might have one though. He might also have a ladder, so let's wait until later for that as well.

Now answer questions 4-6.

4. What does the man think about the curtains?
5. What does the woman think about her parents' house?
6. What might the woman purchase next time?

Transcripts

Section 3:

WOMAN: Hi, my landlord says he does have a drop cloth, but he doesn't have a step ladder. Actually, he does, but it fell apart. So he told me to buy a new one, and he'll pay for it. He says he has an account here—Anthony Dillon?

MAN: Okay . . . let's see . . . yes, he does have an account, and it's all paid up. Good. I'll have one of our standard six-foot step ladders delivered tomorrow! So you're all set!

WOMAN: Great! He's happy that I'm going to paint the room. He even said he'd come help if it's too difficult to do on my own.

MAN: I think he should, since technically you're doing his job for him!

Now answer questions 7-8.

7. Why does her landlord want to buy a new ladder?
8. How does the interaction end?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman about making plans for lunch.

MAN: Hey Aleya, how's your morning going?

WOMAN: Not bad. I'm just finishing this monthly report. There's so much information to gather.

MAN: Well, a bunch of us from our department are going out for lunch today. Why don't you take a break and come with us? It'll do you good to get out of the office for a bit.

WOMAN: Oh, thank you. That sounds wonderful. Where are we going?

MAN: Do you like Italian food? There's a really great place, Mario's, a couple of blocks from here. They have the best pasta in town, and their garlic bread is amazing.

WOMAN: I've never been to an Italian restaurant. I don't eat out very often. The customs and food here are quite different from my home country. Thank you so much for inviting me. I love trying new things.

MAN: I hope you like it. Our team eats there at least once a month. There's also a great sushi place nearby that we go to all the time. You'll have to come with us next time.

WOMAN: It's so interesting that you go to a restaurant so often. The boss is so kind. My former boss never invited us out for meals.

MAN: Just so you know, everybody pays for their own meal. The company would go bankrupt if they paid for all of our lunches all the time!

WOMAN: Sorry, I didn't know. I thought when you invited me that it was paid for. In my home country, the boss pays, or the person who invites pays. I'm a little embarrassed now . . .

MAN: Don't worry about it. In Canada, it's pretty casual. We always pay for ourselves unless someone specifically says they'll treat you, and that doesn't happen very often. Maybe on your birthday, but that's about it.

WOMAN: I'm so glad you told me. I would have felt really bad if I had eaten and then not paid. It's very different, but I will get used to it.

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. Where are the man and the woman?
2. Why is the woman invited out to lunch?
3. What is the woman's opinion of Italian food?
4. Why does the woman think the boss will pay for lunch?
5. What is the woman's decision about going for lunch?

PART 3

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation that takes place in a woman's home.

WOMAN: Hi Harry, thanks for coming by. You've done great work for us before, and now we have a few more jobs we'd like you to do: painting a wall, replacing floor tiles, and changing cupboard handles. What do you think?

MAN: Sounds good. Let's start with the tiles. Where are they going?

WOMAN: In the kitchen. We got a really good deal on these peel-and-stick ones. I love the colour! Do you think these will work on the kitchen floor?

MAN: They're good quality and durable, so you made a good choice. What does the floor surface look like? Can I see it?

WOMAN: Sure, follow me. See, there's some old ripped flooring here. I was hoping you could just put the tiles on top of the old floor here, and match them with the rest of the floor.

MAN: That's going to be a problem. I'll have to remove that old flooring, or the new tiles won't join properly with the rest of the floor. The kitchen floor isn't that big. Why not replace the whole floor with these new tiles? Then it will look really professional. I think you bought enough tiles, but I'll measure later to check that out.

WOMAN: Oh, we didn't think about that. What a good idea!

MAN: Okay, so what do you want me to paint?

WOMAN: Just this one wall where I've filled the holes. I learned how to do that from my dad who enjoyed repairing walls. Do you think it needs to be sanded before you paint? I'm concerned about the dust because I need to make dinner each night.

MAN: Yeah, it definitely needs sanding. My electric sander has a dust catcher, though. Have you already bought the paint?

WOMAN: Yes, we picked it up yesterday when we bought the handles. These are the new handles for the cupboard doors. They're so pretty that I just couldn't resist buying them! Will they fit these doors OK?

MAN: Yeah, they'll go on just fine. Okay, this should take me two, maybe three days. When would you like me to start?

WOMAN: Is tomorrow too soon? I'll be so glad to finally have this work done!

MAN: No problem. I'll just take those measurements and draw up an estimate. I'll give it to you in about ten minutes.

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. Why is the man visiting the woman?
2. What is the woman's plan?
3. What did the woman do by herself?
4. Why does the man suggest putting new tiles on the whole kitchen floor?
5. What is the woman worried about?
6. When will the man be finished?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news story about the effect of recent storms on a community.

Over the past few weeks, storms near Fredericton have damaged many homes and other structures.

One resident, Jila Amini, had recently installed a large children's slide in her garden so that her son and daughter could play outside. Jila woke up last Tuesday morning to discover that the rain and mud had carried her slide down her hilly backyard and into the neighbourhood park. After talking to the town council, Jila discovered that the council was already planning on buying a new slide for the park. The council suggested that Jila leave her slide in the park, and they offered to replace Jila's slide at the council's expense. Jila agreed.

Three nights later, another thunderstorm knocked down an old oak tree in the same park. The tree fell directly on the slide, crushing it beyond repair. The townspeople have decided to make the best of the situation. Led by local artist and wood carver Eddy Galen, a team has started a project to build a new children's climbing structure in the park using wood from the fallen oak tree. When the project is completed, these terrible storms will have benefitted everyone.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion among three colleagues. There are two women and one man. They are at a break room at their workplace.

Tia: Let's enjoy our coffee break as long as we can. These new changes at work are giving me a headache.

Richard: Why are they making the changes?

Tia: Management said that business has grown so much in the last year that they had to hire a lot of new staff. I guess we can't move, so they are making major changes to this old space to accommodate more staff.

Alice: The new plan, called office hoteling, isn't unique to us. As a matter of fact, it's been proven to work extremely well. If you think of our office like a hotel, the idea might come clearer. We reserve a desk before we come to work, and then we check in when we arrive.

Richards: That's an interesting comparison. But I don't see how these tiny desks work compare to a spacious, comfortable hotel room.

Alice: Well, the idea is that many of us aren't in the office every day. Therefore, there are temporary space assignments, like people using a hotel. Those working 9–5 in the office every day still keep their desk, like before. I think it'll be fine; we just need to get used to it.

Tia: I heard that very few people have private offices now. Instead, we will need to book a small seminar room if you're meeting with a client. This will require considerable advanced planning.

Richard: So, what do you do if a client drops to consult with you and there's no seminar rooms available? It'll take considerable time to adjust our work habits to those kinds of changes.

Alice: Well, the other interesting change is that once you check in for a desk, you sign up for a laptop for the rest of the day. We can now access our email on any laptop.

Richard: What I don't like is that these shared desks are basically just bare cubicles. You can't personalize the space or store your own work files. And what about telephones? I don't see telephones at each desk.

Tia: I don't understand how this new phone system works, although I know we can't have a phone at our desk anymore. It's considered too disruptive to others. But what I will miss most is being together with our team and learning from each other.

Alice: Yeah, well, there certainly will be a lot of changes. Maybe having coffee like this together when the three of us are in the office is a good idea. Maybe we should invite some of our other team members to join us—so they can cope, too.

Richard: That's a great idea! Let's do it.

Tia: We'll do team-texting to set up meetings!

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a report about health care in Canada.

As many opinion polls over the years have shown, when asked what makes Canada special, the Canadian health care system is often the most cited reason. For over fifty years, Canada has relied on a system of health care that is government run and free to all Canadians. Private, for-profit health care is only allowed in very few circumstances. When it comes to health care, money will not buy better doctors or a better hospital. Everyone uses the same services.

Canada's health care system is generous, effective, and, most believe, equitable. However, the system is not without its critics. The cost to the government is, of course, huge and this cost is funded by the Canadian people in the form of taxes. While few have argued against the health system itself, arguments against the tax rates required to support the system are not uncommon.

The main criticism of the system, however, is not its cost, but its exclusivity. In almost all cases, the only health care services available are government services. Why can't individuals that can afford to pay for health services go to private clinics? If this were allowed, not only would they get faster, more efficient service, but they would remove themselves from the government system. Everybody would benefit from shorter wait times. Canada is one of the few industrialized countries to effectively ban private medical treatment. Most countries in Europe and Asia support mixed systems where individuals can choose between public and private options.

Many in Canada are opposed to a mixed system in which more wealthy citizens receive different—and perhaps—better health care. The fear is that once the wealthy leave the public system, they will be even less motivated to pay the taxes required to maintain the public health care system. Moreover, there is a moral issue at stake: Is it right that some people in society receive better health care than others?

Those who support a mixed system also say they see a moral issue. In a free country such as Canada, people should have the right to choose where they go for their health care.

Compromise solutions have also been suggested. Perhaps private practices could be allowed for screening, but not for treatment. People could have private medical tests, X-rays or ultrasounds, but they would have to get treatment in the public system.

The debate will continue for years to come. However, there is little evidence that the health system will change in the near future. Canadians are proud of their health system and change to that system is likely to be slow in coming.